DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION:

This project was designed to develop essential digital skills required in today's academic and professional environment. As a Student Digital Ambassador, the objective was to create awareness about digital literacy, build a professional online presence, explore coding and collaboration platforms, and understand the importance of effective digital communication and cybersecurity.

The project consists of five tasks, each focusing on a different aspect of digital development. It includes creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, practising coding, designing collaborative tools, and learning professional communication and online safety. Through these tasks, I gained both theoretical knowledge and practical experience. Overall, the project highlights the importance of using digital tools responsibly, efficiently, and professionally in real-world scenarios.

TASK 1: CREATE A DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

I created a Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using Canva. The platform provided a wide range of templates, icons, and design features that helped me organize and present information in a clear and visually appealing format. I focused on making the infographic simple, informative, and easy for students to understand at a glance.

My infographic covers three key areas: digital literacy, safe internet practices, and maintaining a professional online presence. I described digital literacy as the ability to use digital technologies effectively, responsibly, and ethically in everyday life. Under safe internet practices, I included important points such as using strong and unique passwords, avoiding suspicious links, protecting personal information, and being aware of online scams and cyber threats. I also emphasized the importance of maintaining a professional online presence by using respectful communication, following proper email etiquette, and being careful about the content shared on social media platforms.

While designing the infographic, I found it interesting how the use of colors, icons, and layout can improve understanding and make information more engaging for viewers. One challenge I faced was selecting the most relevant information and organizing it in a neat and balanced way without overcrowding the design. This task helped me improve my understanding of digital literacy concepts while also enhancing my creativity, design thinking, and communication skills.

TASK 2- BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

I am Mousumi Parida, Registration no.-25BHI10137 a student of Computer Science Engineering (Health Informatics) at VIT Bhopal University, from the 2025 batch. I have a strong interest in improving my problem-solving skills through Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA). Along with this, I am currently learning web development and exploring machine learning concepts to build a solid foundation in both fields.

As part of my digital portfolio, I created profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. On GitHub, I have set up my profile with a README that introduces me and highlights my interests. It serves as a platform where I can upload my coding projects, practice DSA, and track my progress over time. I believe it will help me showcase my skills and growth in a structured way.

On LinkedIn, I created a professional profile where I have added my academic details and basic information. It helps me connect with other students, seniors, and professionals, which allows me to stay updated with opportunities and industry trends. On Kaggle, I created an account to explore data science and machine learning. Although I am just starting, I plan to use it to work with datasets, learn from notebooks, and gradually participate in competitions and showcase my skills.

In the coming years, I aim to regularly update my GitHub with meaningful projects, including DSA practice, web development applications, and beginner-level machine learning projects, so that I can clearly track my growth and showcase my work. On LinkedIn, I plan to actively share my learning journey, achievements, certifications, and project updates to build a strong professional presence and connect with like-minded individuals and industry professionals. On Kaggle, I want to consistently practice using real-world datasets, explore different approaches, and gradually participate in competitions to improve my problem-solving and analytical skills.

By using these platforms regularly and effectively, I hope to build a strong technical profile, gain practical experience, and prepare myself for internships and future career opportunities in the tech field.

TASK 3 - EXPLORE CODING AND COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

In this task, I gained hands-on experience with both coding and digital collaboration tools by using HackerRank and Google Workspace. I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level programming challenge, which strengthened my understanding of core concepts of DSA such as logical thinking, problem-solving, and basic programming syntax and its applications. The platform's real-time feedback and scoring system helped me identify mistakes and improve my coding approach.

As part of the collaboration task, I built a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The form included five well-structured questions, combining multiple-choice and short-answer formats, focusing on topics like online safety, digital responsibility, and awareness of common cyber risks. I also connected the form to Google Sheets to automatically collect and organize responses, allowing easy analysis of participant answers.

Through this task, I built both a functional quiz and a coding solution, which enhanced my practical skills. Academically, HackerRank helped me improve my programming fundamentals and analytical thinking, which are essential for computer science subjects and technical interviews which I will be facing in coming future for get into the tech companies as a software engineer. Meanwhile, Google Workspace tools improved my ability to create digital content, manage data, and collaborate efficiently with others.

Overall, this experience increased my technical confidence, digital literacy, and productivity skills, all of which will support my academic performance and future career growth.

TASK 4– EMAIL ETIQUETTE

In this task, I explored the importance of professional digital communication through email writing and etiquette. A common situation where poor communication can cause problems is when a student sends an email to a professor without a clear subject line, proper greeting, or polite tone. For example, if a student writes a vague message like “Send details” without context or uses informal language, the professor may not understand the request or may ignore the email altogether. This can lead to missed information, confusion, or delays in academic work.

Through this task, I learned that effective communication requires clarity, respect, and proper structure. Every professional email should include a clear and relevant subject line, a formal greeting, a concise and well-organized message, and a proper closing. It is also important to clearly state the purpose of the email and provide necessary details so that the recipient can respond appropriately.

If the student in the scenario had followed these guidelines, the issue could have been avoided. A properly written email would have made the request clear and increased the chances of receiving a timely response.

Overall, this task highlighted that good digital communication is essential for building a positive impression, avoiding misunderstandings, and maintaining strong academic and professional relationships.

TASK 5 – CYBERCRIME AND CYBER AWARENESS

While researching cybercrime, what surprised me the most was how easily people become victims of online fraud without any advanced hacking being involved. Most cybercrimes, especially UPI and online payment fraud, rely on simple psychological tricks such as creating urgency, fear, or trust. For example, fraudsters pretend to be bank officials or customer support agents and convince users to share OTPs or approve payment requests. It was surprising to learn that even educated users can fall for these scams due to a lack of awareness or momentary panic.

I also realized that many people are not fully aware of basic digital safety practices, such as verifying links or understanding how UPI transactions actually work. This makes them more vulnerable to such attacks.

One important habit I will change is being more cautious and alert while using digital platforms, especially for financial transactions. I will always verify the authenticity of messages, links, or payment requests before taking any action. I will also avoid scanning unknown QR codes and ensure that I never share my OTP, PIN, or personal information with anyone.

This learning has made me more responsible and aware, and it will help me maintain better digital security in my daily life.

CONCLUSION:

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and its practical applications. Through all five tasks, I developed skills in design, professional communication, coding, collaboration, and cybersecurity awareness. Creating an infographic improved my creativity, while building a digital portfolio helped me establish an online professional presence. Exploring coding platforms enhanced my problem-solving abilities, and drafting emails strengthened my communication skills. Learning about cybercrime increased my awareness of online safety. Overall, this project helped me become more confident, responsible, and efficient in using digital tools, which will support my academic growth and future career development.

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